

Partnership Intelligence Profile

WakeMed Health & Hospitals

University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill — Office of Innovation and Commercialization

Prepared: May 2026 | **Slug:** wakemed | **Classification:** Internal Use

Overview

WakeMed Health & Hospitals is a private, not-for-profit health care system headquartered in Raleigh, North Carolina, and the largest health system in Wake County — the state’s most populous county. Founded in 1961 as Memorial Hospital of Wake County, WakeMed operates a 973-bed system comprising three full-service acute care hospitals, a mental health and well-being hospital, a rehabilitation hospital, four healthplexes with 24/7 emergency departments, and a network of more than 175 physician and physical therapy practice offices, all concentrated in the Triangle area. In fiscal year 2025, WakeMed reported \$2.6 billion in total operating revenue, served more than 354,000 emergency visits, and delivered more than 10,400 babies — more than any other health system in Wake County.

Unlike the other North Carolina health systems in this profile series, WakeMed has no academic medical center affiliation, no medical school, and no NCI-designated cancer center. It is a mission-driven community health system whose competitive strengths are patient volume, geographic saturation of Wake County, trauma and rehabilitation leadership, a Magnet-recognized nursing program, and a growing portfolio of digital and AI partnerships integrated into its Epic platform.

The profile’s most consequential recent development is a proposed strategic combination with Atrium Health, announced May 6–7, 2026, which is pending Wake County commissioner approval, NC attorney general review, and FTC review. If completed, this combination would align WakeMed with Atrium and its parent enterprise Advocate Health — placing North Carolina’s largest health system alongside its largest community health system in a single network directly competing with UNC Health across the Triangle.

Sources: WakeMed About Us [1]; WakeMed FY2025 Statistical Highlights [2]; WakeMed/Atrium Announcement [3].

Basic Organizational Information

Field	Value
Full Name	WakeMed Health & Hospitals
Headquarters	3000 New Bern Avenue, Raleigh, North Carolina 27610
Website	https://www.wakemed.org
Org Type	Private, Not-for-Profit Health Care System
Revenue	\$2,617,994,430 total operating revenue (FY2025, audited)
Employees	12,899 (FY2025); 12,500+ including all staff categories
Licensed Beds	973
Hospitals	3 acute care + 1 mental health + 1 rehabilitation
Emergency Departments	8 (including 4 healthplex-based 24/7 EDs)
Physician Practices	176 practice locations; 542 physicians; 502 APPs
CEO	Donald R. Gintzig, President & CEO (since 2013)
EHR Platform	Epic (live ~2015; ~\$100M implementation investment)

Sources: WakeMed By the Numbers [4]; WakeMed FY2025 Statistical Highlights [2]; WakeMed About Us [1].

System Scale and Structure

Acute Care Hospitals

WakeMed Raleigh Campus is the flagship facility at 3000 New Bern Avenue, a 587-licensed-bed tertiary referral hospital and the only Level I Trauma Center in Wake County and one of seven in North Carolina. The Raleigh Campus houses WakeMed Children's Hospital — the only dedicated pediatric inpatient care facility in Wake County — along with a dedicated children's emergency department, the WakeMed Rehabilitation Hospital (73 licensed beds), and WakeMed WakeBrook Mental Health & Well-Being Hospital (28 licensed beds). In FY2025, the Raleigh Campus recorded 39,101 discharges, 126,823 emergency visits, and 5,340 trauma patients.

WakeMed Cary Hospital is a 208-licensed-bed full-service community hospital in Cary serving western Wake County. It holds a Level III Trauma Center designation and in FY2025 recorded 19,343 discharges, 51,242 emergency visits, and 3,461 births.

WakeMed North Hospital is a 77-licensed-bed facility in North Raleigh operating under the Raleigh Campus license. In FY2025 it recorded 10,087 discharges, 52,941 emergency visits, and 2,109 births. WakeMed delivers more babies than any other health system in Wake County; combined FY2025 births across Raleigh, Cary, and North totaled 10,475.

Healthplexes and Ambulatory Network

Four healthplexes — Apex, Brier Creek, Garner, and Wendell — provide stand-alone 24/7 emergency departments and outpatient services across Wake County, collectively contributing 122,857 emergency visits in FY2025. WakeMed Physician Practices spans 176 office locations with 542 physicians and 502 advanced practice providers, generating 903,160 physician practice visits in FY2025.

Community Benefit

WakeMed's total estimated direct community benefit in FY2025 was \$353,656,150, including unreimbursed costs for charity care, Medicare, and Medicaid patients, health professions education, and community health outreach. WakeMed made the Lown Institute's 2025 list of the nation's most socially responsible hospitals.

Sources: WakeMed FY2025 Statistical Highlights [2]; WakeMed By the Numbers [4]; WakeMed Newsroom [5].

Quality, Rankings, and Accreditation

Magnet Recognition with Distinction — First in North Carolina

In September 2025, WakeMed became the first health system in North Carolina to earn Magnet Recognition with Distinction from the American Nurses Credentialing Center — one of only 47 health care organizations in the world to hold this designation at that time. Magnet with Distinction is the ANCC's highest recognition for nursing excellence.

U.S. News & World Report 2025–26

WakeMed Raleigh Campus and North Hospital together earned High Performing ratings in 13 of 22 benchmark procedures and conditions in the U.S. News 2025–26 Best Hospitals: Procedures & Conditions ratings. WakeMed Raleigh Campus holds one nationally ranked specialty and is ranked

No. 14 in North Carolina and No. 6 in the Raleigh-Durham metro area. WakeMed Cary Hospital, Raleigh Campus, and North Hospital all earned High Performing designations in U.S. News's 2026 Best Hospitals for Maternity Care.

Rehabilitation

WakeMed Rehabilitation Hospital was ranked among the top 50 rehabilitation hospitals nationally by U.S. News and ranked No. 1 in North Carolina by Newsweek's Best Physical Rehabilitation Centers ranking.

Additional Recognitions

WakeMed was named to Money magazine's 2026 Best Hospitals for Pediatric Care list — one of only three NC hospitals on the national list of 75. WakeMed Raleigh, Cary, and North hospitals were named to Newsweek's 2026 list of America's Best Maternity Hospitals for the fifth consecutive year. WakeMed Cary Hospital was named to the inaugural Forbes Best Hospitals list (February 2026).

Sources: WakeMed Newsroom [6]; WakeMed Awards [8]; WakeMed Newsroom [9].

Research Infrastructure

WakeMed operates without a formal affiliated medical school, NCI-designated cancer center, or NIH-funded CTSA. Its research profile is community-focused and program-based rather than externally funded academic research infrastructure.

PreciselyYou — Community Genomics Research Program

PreciselyYou is WakeMed's community health research program that uses participants' DNA to identify how genetics influences individual health outcomes and to support new research discoveries for the Wake County population.

Teaching Hospital Status and Graduate Medical Education

WakeMed Raleigh Campus holds teaching hospital designation and participates in graduate medical education. WakeMed operates a residency program at the Raleigh Campus under a documented affiliation with the UNC School of Medicine — the UNC School of Medicine Raleigh Campus — placing UNC medical students and residents in clinical training at WakeMed facilities. This affiliation is the most significant documented institutional connection between WakeMed and UNC.

Bamboo Health — Care Coordination Analytics

WakeMed selected Bamboo Health's Real-Time Care Intelligence platform to support care coordination across its three acute care hospitals, eight emergency departments, and physician practice network.

Sources: WakeMed PreciselyYou [10]; WakeMed Raleigh Campus residency page [11]; Bamboo Health [12].

Digital and AI Infrastructure

Epic EHR Platform

WakeMed implemented Epic as its enterprise EHR across its hospitals and physician practices following a nearly \$100 million implementation investment first announced in 2012, with the system going live approximately in 2015. WakeMed built a location-technology integration with MapQuest's API inside Epic that allows patients to navigate to the most convenient emergency department and auto-notify ED clinicians of estimated arrival time.

Regard AI — Clinical Documentation and Diagnosis (2024)

In May 2024, WakeMed entered a three-year enterprise agreement with Regard, an AI clinical platform that operates within the Epic EHR and uses proprietary algorithms to review patient clinical data, surface diagnostic insights for clinicians, and improve documentation quality. WakeMed deployed Regard across its three acute care hospitals by the end of 2024.

Rezilient CloudClinics — Hybrid Virtual Care (2025–26)

In December 2025, WakeMed announced a partnership with Rezilient Health, positioning WakeMed as one of the first health systems in the United States to integrate the Rezilient hybrid CloudClinic model. Four Rezilient with WakeMed CloudClinic locations opened across the Triangle in early 2026 — in Cary, Chapel Hill, North Raleigh, and Clayton — each fully integrated with WakeMed's Epic EHR. The service launched initially for WakeMed's 12,500 employees at no copay and is planned to expand to corporate clients in 2027.

Sources: Becker's Hospital Review [13]; WakeMed Newsroom [14]; Regard/WakeMed [15].

Strategic Themes

- \$2.6 billion in audited operating revenue (FY2025), with \$223.6 million in operating cash flow — financially stable and capital-active.
 - First health system in North Carolina to earn ANCC Magnet Recognition with Distinction (September 2025) — one of 47 organizations worldwide.
 - Saturated Wake County footprint: 3 full-service hospitals, 4 healthplexes, 8 emergency departments, and 176 physician practice locations.
 - Epic-integrated AI portfolio expanding: Regard (2024), Rezilient CloudClinics (2026), Bamboo Health.
 - Rezilient CloudClinic locations include Chapel Hill — a deliberate geographic move into UNC Health's primary market.
 - Proposed Atrium Health combination announced May 2026, pending regulatory approval — the most significant structural development in Wake County health care since WakeMed's own founding.
 - CEO Donald Gintzig's stated rationale for the Atrium combination: WakeMed will “survive but not thrive alone”.
 - WakeMed Children's Hospital and Level I Trauma Center are the only facilities of their kind in Wake County.
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Alignment with UNC Research

No formal OIC-level UNC–WakeMed institutional research or commercialization partnership has been identified from the current source set. The most significant documented institutional connection is WakeMed's clinical training affiliation with the UNC School of Medicine at the Raleigh Campus.

Three Strategic Framing Pillars for UNC

Clinical education affiliation as partnership foundation: WakeMed's UNC School of Medicine Raleigh Campus affiliation places UNC students and residents inside WakeMed's clinical environment.

Wake County community health data and population reach: WakeMed's 354,000-plus annual emergency visits, 71,000-plus discharges, and 10,400-plus births constitute a population health dataset of significant scale.

Digital health and AI as the emerging common ground: WakeMed's Regard deployment, Rezilient CloudClinic partnership, and Epic integration activity signal active investment in clinical AI evaluation.

Specific UNC Research Fit Areas

- **Emergency medicine, trauma, and pediatric care:** Sole providers of Level I Trauma and pediatric inpatient in Wake County.
- **Maternal and neonatal outcomes:** Most births in Wake County; ideal community partner for outcomes research.
- **Behavioral health:** WakeMed WakeBrook and the proposed Atrium combination's \$2 billion behavioral health investment.
- **Digital health implementation and clinical AI:** Regard and Rezilient implementations integrated into Epic.
- **Community genomics:** WakeMed's PreciselyYou program.

Sources: WakeMed Raleigh Campus residency page [11]; WakeMed Newsroom [3]; WakeMed PreciselyYou [10].

Talking Points

Organizational Context

- WakeMed is the largest health system in Wake County, with \$2.6 billion in audited operating revenue in FY2025, 973 licensed beds, 12,500-plus employees.
- WakeMed is not an academic health system and has no medical school or NCI-designated cancer center.
- The proposed Atrium Health combination, announced May 2026, is the single most important development in WakeMed's strategic trajectory.
- WakeMed is North Carolina's first health system to earn ANCC Magnet Recognition with Distinction, one of 47 worldwide.

Research and Innovation Relevance

- WakeMed's research infrastructure is community-focused — PreciselyYou (genomics), UNC School of Medicine Raleigh Campus GME affiliation, and a growing AI implementation portfolio.
- The Regard and Rezilient deployments make WakeMed one of the more active community health systems in the Triangle for clinical AI evaluation.

- WakeMed’s patient population data is a distinct research asset from the academic patient populations at UNC and Duke.
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Risk and Caution Notes

- The proposed Atrium Health combination was announced May 6–7, 2026. It remains pending Wake County commissioner approval, NC attorney general review, and FTC review.
 - WakeMed has no affiliated medical school and no CTSA. Do not imply research infrastructure equivalence with UNC, Duke, or Atrium Health Wake Forest Baptist.
 - The UNC School of Medicine Raleigh Campus affiliation involves GME clinical training — it is a clinical education relationship, not a research or OIC-level institutional agreement.
 - WakeMed’s PreciselyYou program scale, data governance, and accessibility have not been independently verified.
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Expected Report Angle and Positioning

Positioning Summary: WakeMed should be framed as (1) Wake County’s dominant community health system — a \$2.6 billion, 973-bed private nonprofit; (2) a nursing excellence leader, the first NC system to earn ANCC Magnet Recognition with Distinction; (3) an active clinical AI and digital health adopter, with enterprise-wide Regard AI and Rezilient CloudClinic deployments; (4) a system without academic research infrastructure but with community patient volume and population health geography; and (5) a system at a strategic inflection point, with a proposed May 2026 combination with Atrium Health.

References

- [1] WakeMed — About Us — <https://www.wakemed.org/about-us>
- [2] WakeMed — FY2025 Statistical Highlights (PDF)
- [3] WakeMed Newsroom — WakeMed and Atrium Health Announce Planned Strategic Combination (May 6, 2026)
- [4] WakeMed — By the Numbers
- [5] WakeMed Newsroom — Rezilient CloudClinic Opens in Clayton (March 17, 2026)

- [6] WakeMed Newsroom — First NC Health System Magnet Recognition with Distinction (September 19, 2025)
- [7] WakeMed Newsroom — Named to Money's 2026 List of Best Hospitals for Pediatric Care (April 2026)
- [8] WakeMed — Awards and Accreditations
- [9] WakeMed Newsroom — Named Among Best Maternity Hospitals (December 2025)
- [10] WakeMed — PreciselyYou Community Research Program
- [11] WakeMed — UNC School of Medicine Raleigh Campus
- [12] AI-Techpark — WakeMed selects Bamboo Health (2024)
- [13] Becker's Hospital Review — WakeMed deploys location tech in Epic EHR (2020)
- [14] WakeMed Newsroom — WakeMed integrates Rezilient CloudClinics (December 2025)
- [15] PRNewswire — Regard and WakeMed Enterprise Agreement (May 2024)
- [16] Becker's Hospital Review — Why WakeMed's CEO Says His System Will Survive But Not Thrive Alone (May 2026)
- [17] NC Health News — Atrium Health Targets WakeMed in Proposed Combination (May 2026)